

Derek C. Carter

Staff Developer Advocate
Platform Engineering Leader
Technical Training &
Education Specialist
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Summary:

Developer Advocate and Technical Education Leader with 15+ years designing developer education programs and building distributed systems platforms. Expert in creating technical curricula, delivering hands-on workshops, and developing training materials that accelerate developer adoption of complex technologies. Proven track record mentoring engineering teams, leading cross-functional developer experience initiatives, and building educational content for platform engineering and distributed systems. Experience spans startups to Fortune 500 companies, with extensive background in Linux training, technical consulting, and courseware development serving development teams ranging from 8 to 50+ engineers.

Experience

VidAngel (vidangel.com) – DevOps Engineer – Jun 2025 - Feb 2026

DevOps Engineer focused on cloud infrastructure automation, developer platform improvements, and CI/CD pipeline optimization for a streaming media company.

- Designed self-hosted HashiCorp Vault architecture with high-availability cluster, automated key management, and load balancing, targeting 99.95% service availability and delivering projected annual cost savings of \$3,400.
- Redesigned backend deployment pipeline using GitLab CI/CD with atomic deployments and version management, implementing hash-based dependency packaging and automated rollback capabilities via Ansible.
- Built automated golden image pipeline using Packer and Ansible, creating standardized AMI base operating system images with integrated monitoring, logging agents, and access control settings across all environments.
- Deployed self-hosted GitLab CI/CD runners on Kubernetes infrastructure, reducing external dependencies and improving build security with custom runner images containing required development tooling.
- Expanded Infrastructure as Code adoption through reusable Terraform modules for networking and access management, establishing consistent deployment patterns and accelerating team on boarding.

Unchained (unchained.com) – Senior Software Engineer / DevOps Team Lead – May 2023 - Mar 2025

Senior DevOps Team Lead and Engineering Manager leading platform transformation and cloud infrastructure modernization for cryptocurrency/blockchain distributed systems company with 50+ engineering team members.

- Established Request for Comments (RFC) process for engineering architecture decisions, creating educational workshops on distributed systems design patterns and improving cross-team collaboration.
- Led GitLab Enterprise migration from hosted GitHub, conducting comprehensive training programs for development teams on new workflows and security best practices.
 - Architected enterprise-wide deployment platform with standardized CI/CD pipelines, supporting 30+ services across multiple environments and enabling developer self-service capabilities through documentation and training.
 - Implemented private GitLab CI/CD runners on company-owned infrastructure, delivering hands-on workshops on containerized build environments and security compliance.
- Enhanced Terraform Infrastructure as Code with Terragrunt multi-environment architecture, creating comprehensive training materials and runbooks for consistent infrastructure deployment across development, staging, and production environments.
- Designed and deployed multi-environment cloud architecture with fault tolerance and state management, conducting technical knowledge transfer sessions to reduce deployment errors and improve developer experience.

- Implemented Role Based Access Control (RBAC) system using Terraform and Terragrunt automation, creating documentation and training programs to strengthen security posture.
- Managed team of 2 DevOps engineers and established rotating “DevOps Residency Program” to embed DevOps practices across 8 development teams through mentoring, pair programming, and educational workshops, improving deployment frequency.

UserTesting (usertesting.com) – Staff Software Engineer / Ops and Infrastructure Team Lead – Mar 2021 - Mar 2023

Staff Site Reliability Engineer leading 7-person infrastructure team supporting enterprise-scale distributed systems platform serving millions of monthly active users. Architected fault-tolerant Kubernetes-based microservices platform with event-driven architecture.

- Led agile team management and quarterly OKR planning for infrastructure engineering team, balancing technical debt reduction with new feature delivery across 100+ microservices distributed systems architecture.
- Established engineering best practices and led DevOps Guild and Cross-Squad Architecture Guild, creating educational programs and workshops that standardized deployment practices across 15 development teams.
- Designed and delivered technical training sessions on microservices architecture, distributed systems patterns, and platform engineering best practices to development teams.
- Ensured enterprise security compliance (SOC2, SOX, GDPR, ISO27001) through infrastructure automation and security tooling implementation, maintaining compliance audits.
- Enhanced developer experience through platform engineering initiatives and educational content:
 - Developed reusable GitHub Actions and CircleCI pipeline templates with comprehensive documentation and training materials, reducing CI/CD setup time for new microservices.
 - Created standardized Infrastructure as Code templates and runbooks for rapid microservice deployment, including developer onboarding documentation.
 - Migrated critical internal applications from Heroku to self-managed Kubernetes infrastructure, conducting knowledge transfer sessions and creating operational guides.
- Maintained and optimized AWS Elastic Container Service (ECS) legacy infrastructure supporting high-availability production workloads with state management and concurrency controls.
- Architected modern container orchestration platform using Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service (EKS), Terraform Infrastructure as Code, and GitOps deployment methodology.

Nav (nav.com) – Principal Software Engineer DevOps – Aug 2017 - Feb 2021

Principal software engineer with a focus on DevOps and platform engineering for distributed financial services systems. Architected, deployed and maintained the developer platform and infrastructure for a late-stage fintech startup. Led platform transformation migrating traditional Amazon AWS infrastructure to fault-tolerant Kubernetes-based developer platform.

- Mitigated legacy distributed architecture problems using automation (Ansible), security tools (HashiCorp Vault), and systems operations expertise, creating comprehensive documentation and training materials.
 - Created open-source tool [vault_helper](#) to ease the rotation of encryption keys in distributed HashiCorp Vault systems, with detailed usage documentation.
- Built new Kubernetes platform with service mesh architecture and migrated legacy applications, conducting extensive knowledge transfer sessions.
 - Built hybrid architecture to allow legacy apps and new (k8s) apps to communicate seamlessly across distributed systems, creating architectural decision records and developer guides.
- Improved developer workflow processes and tooling through education and standardization.
 - Created company-wide engineering standards documentation, including JSON logging standards, secret management practices, and code release workflows with comprehensive training programs.

- Built a “canary application” demonstrating distributed systems patterns and platform capabilities, serving as educational reference for development teams.
- Built a centralized CI/CD pipeline platform with self-service deployment capabilities, creating extensive documentation and conducting training workshops to reduce cognitive load and deployment friction.
- Migrated all infrastructure creation from ad-hoc solutions to HashiCorp Terraform Infrastructure as Code, creating reusable modules and conducting training sessions on best practices.
- Implemented RunDocs for every application with comprehensive operational guides, bringing operations and development into alignment through shared knowledge and documentation.

Goozbach Infrastructure Solutions, LLC (goozbach.com) – Linux Infrastructure Consultant and Technical Training Specialist – Dec 2011 – Present

Owner and primary consultant of Linux consulting and technical education company providing enterprise training programs, distributed systems consulting, and developer education services. Customers include RedHat training partners, Linux Foundation, enterprise technology companies, and Federal Government including Department of Defense. Customer environments range from dozens to thousands of servers across distributed infrastructure.

Services provided include technical curriculum development, hands-on workshop delivery, configuration management training, DevOps education programs, and distributed systems architecture consulting.

- Designed and delivered comprehensive DevOps training programs covering distributed systems, platform engineering tools, continuous integration (Jenkins), automated testing frameworks (Test Anything Protocol, Rspec), configuration management (Puppet, Ansible, Salt), and infrastructure automation (PXE, Kickstart) for enterprise development teams.
- Created custom technical training curricula and certification pathways for enterprise customers, including hands-on workshops, competency frameworks, and train-the-trainer programs.
- Developed and maintained virtual/hybrid classroom infrastructure supporting interactive technical education delivery for distributed learning environments.
- Led infrastructure consulting for enterprise customers on distributed systems architecture, fault tolerance patterns, and platform engineering best practices.
- Created comprehensive Linux courseware and educational content, including interactive labs, assessment frameworks, and certification programs delivered to hundreds of developers and system administrators.

Technical Skills

Developer Advocacy & Education: Technical Curriculum Design • Workshop Development & Delivery • Train-the-Trainer Programs • Certification Frameworks • Technical Content Creation

Distributed Systems: Fault Tolerance • State Management • Concurrency • Event-Driven Architecture • Microservices • Service Mesh

Programming Languages: Go • Python • TypeScript • Java • Bash • Infrastructure as Code (Terraform/Terragrunt)

Platform Engineering: Internal Developer Platforms • Developer Self-Service • Golden Paths • Platform Orchestration

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS • GCP • Azure • Kubernetes • Docker • Container Orchestration • Distributed Infrastructure

CI/CD & Automation: GitLab Pipelines • GitHub Actions • ArgoCD • Jenkins • Ansible • Packer • Git

Observability: Grafana • DataDog • Prometheus • New Relic • SLO/SLI • Metrics & Alerting

Security & Compliance: HashiCorp Vault • SOC2/SOX/GDPR/ISO27001 • Enterprise Security Architecture

Training & Education Technologies: Virtual/Hybrid Classroom Infrastructure • Interactive Labs • Assessment Platforms • Educational Content Management

Open Source

- github.com/goozbach
- gitlab.com/users/goozbach/projects

Presentations & Speaking

- presentation.goozbach.com

Further Experience

Find the remainder of my experience on [LinkedIn](#).